Pan-Fried Broccolini, Lemon-Dressed

Serves 4 · About 15 minutes · Cast-iron skillet

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb broccolini

For the pan

- 1 tsp olive oil
- Salt, black pepper, red pepper flakes

Finishing dressing, off heat

- 2 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil
- Juice of ½ lemon
- Zest of 1 lemon
- ¼ tsp garlic powder
- Pinch each salt, black pepper, red pepper flakes

METHOD

1. **Prep.** Cut away the dried ends. Any stalk thicker than a pencil gets halved lengthwise. Dry the broccolini well — water caught in the florets will steam it instead of browning it.
2. **Season.** Toss with 1 tsp oil, salt, pepper, and flakes. Go light; the dressing adds plenty more.
3. **Pan fry.** Heat cast iron over medium-high until it just begins to smoke. Lay the broccolini in a single layer, cut side down. Leave it undisturbed 2–3 minutes, until the stalks have real color, then toss and cook 2 minutes more. A knife tip should slide into the stem with slight resistance, not none.
4. **Dress.** Take the pan off the heat. Whisk the dressing ingredients together in a bowl, add the broccolini, and toss to coat. Serve warm.

NOTES

- Zest first, juice second — a whole lemon is far easier to grate.
- Two batches beat one crowded pan. Crowded broccolini steams.
- Dress it just before it goes to the table; it wilts if it sits in the lemon.

IF THE PAN JUST COOKED STEAK

- Pour off all but a thin film of fat and skip the oil in step 2.
- Rest the pan off heat a minute, then cook over medium — post-sear cast iron will scorch the fond.
- Keep golden fond; wipe out anything blackened.
- Salt lightly. The rendered fat and leftover seasoning carry their own.
- Whisk the steak's resting juices into the dressing.

Adapted from a recipe supplied by the cook (source unattributed). Method rewritten and condensed for personal kitchen use.